

Olympiad Test Paper — Sanskrit (Class 7)

Chapter 7: ईशावास्यम् इदं सर्वम् (Ishavasyam Idam Sarvam)

Subject	Sanskrit (NCERT Class 7, Deepakam)
Chapter	7 — ईशावास्यम् इदं सर्वम् (Ishavasyam Idam Sarvam)
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Questions test the verse's meaning and grammar. Watch the classic traps: ईश means 'Lord' (root ईश्), nothing to do with English '-ish'; ब्रह्म (neuter, the Absolute) differs from ब्रह्मन् (a priest) and ब्रह्मा (the creator-god); सर्वशक्तिमान् uses the -मत्/-वत् suffix ('possessing') to mean ALL-POWERFUL; दास्यन्ति is FUTURE tense ('they shall give', the -स्य- marker), not present or past; and यक्ष/गन्धर्व/किन्नर are SEMI-divine, below the gods. Sanskrit is quoted in Devanagari. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. ईशावास्यम् इदं सर्वम् means:

- (A) the Lord is only in temples (B) nothing is divine
(C) all this is pervaded by the Lord (D) the world has no creator

2. ईशावास्यम् is glossed as ईश्वरेण व्याप्तम्, meaning:

- (A) pervaded by the Lord (B) ruled by a king
(C) made of gold (D) without God

3. इदं सर्वम् in the verse means:

- (A) this one thing (B) nothing at all
(C) only the temple (D) all this (the whole world)

4. The verse's central claim is that God:

- (A) exists only in the sky (B) pervades everything, everywhere
(C) is found only in idols (D) does not exist

5. ईशावास्यम् इदं सर्वम् is the famous opening line of the:

- (A) Ramayana (B) Arthashastra
(C) Ishopanishad (Isha Upanishad) (D) a fox fable

6. If everything is 'pervaded by the Lord', the chapter suggests one should treat the world with:

- (A) reverence and care
(C) greed

- (B) contempt
(D) indifference

7. ईश here means:

- (A) the Lord (the Supreme)
(C) a fox

- (B) the English suffix '-ish'
(D) a flower

8. ईश comes from the root ईश्, meaning:

- (A) 'to eat'
(C) 'to sleep'

- (B) 'to drink'
(D) 'to rule, to own'

9. A well-known derivative of ईश is:

- (A) किंशुक
(C) ईश्वर ('Lord')

- (B) शृगालः
(D) घटः

10. Treating ईश like the English '-ish' suffix is wrong because ईश is:

- (A) an English ending
(B) a Sanskrit word meaning 'Lord', from the root ईश्
(C) a fox
(D) a number

11. ईश and ईश्वर are related because they:

- (A) share the root ईश् ('to rule'), both naming the Supreme
(B) are opposites
(C) mean 'student'
(D) mean 'sun'

12. In this verse, ब्रह्म (neuter) refers to:

- (A) the Absolute (the impersonal Supreme that pervades all)
(B) a priest
(C) the creator-god
(D) a fox

13. ब्रह्मन् (masculine) means:

- (A) the Absolute
(C) a flower
(B) the creator-god
(D) a priest

14. ब्रह्मा (masculine) means:

- (A) a priest
(C) a student
(B) the impersonal Absolute
(D) the creator-god

15. ईशावास्यम् refers to which of the three?

- (A) ब्रह्मन् (a priest)
(C) ब्रह्मा (the creator)
(B) the neuter ब्रह्म (the Absolute)
(D) none of them

16. Sanskrit distinguishes ब्रह्म, ब्रह्मन् and ब्रह्मा by:

- (A) colour
(C) price
(B) gender and spelling
(D) the time of day

17. Confusing ब्रह्म, ब्रह्मन् and ब्रह्मा is a common error because they:

- (A) look similar but name three different things
- (B) are spelled identically
- (C) mean exactly the same
- (D) are all verbs

18. सर्वशक्तिमान् means:

- (A) all-knowing
- (B) all-seeing
- (C) all-powerful / omnipotent
- (D) powerless

19. सर्वशक्तिमान् breaks into सर्व + शक्ति + -मत्/-मान्, meaning:

- (A) 'having no power'
- (B) 'one power only'
- (C) 'possessing all power'
- (D) 'all knowledge'

20. The suffix -मत्/-वत् (as in -मान्) means:

- (A) 'lacking'
- (B) 'like'
- (C) 'to / for'
- (D) 'possessing'

21. सर्वशक्तिमान् describes God as possessing:

- (A) many separate gadgets
- (B) no power at all
- (C) the quality of all-power (omnipotence)
- (D) only physical strength

22. Reading सर्वशक्तिमान् as 'one who has powers (several items)' misses that the suffix marks:

- (A) a plural of objects
- (B) the past tense
- (C) the dative case
- (D) possession of the QUALITY of all-power

23. A word like बुद्धिमान् ('intelligent') uses the same -मत्/-वत् suffix to mean:

- (A) 'lacking intelligence'
- (B) 'possessing intelligence'
- (C) 'like intelligence'
- (D) 'to intelligence'

24. आराधनम् means:

- (A) worship
- (B) meditation
- (C) Name-chanting
- (D) a stain

25. ध्यानम् means:

- (A) meditation
- (B) worship
- (C) Name-chanting
- (D) a family

26. नामकीर्तनम् means:

- (A) worship by offerings
- (B) silent meditation
- (C) chanting / singing the Name (in praise)
- (D) a stain on the family

27. नामकीर्तनम् breaks into नाम + कीर्तनम्, meaning:

- (A) 'family' + 'stain'
- (B) 'all' + 'power'
- (C) 'Name' + 'praise-singing' = chanting the Name

(D) 'Lord' + 'pervaded'

28. बुद्धिमन्तः जनाः ईश्वरं कथं स्मरन्ति? (How do the wise remember God?)

(A) by quarrelling

(B) by meditation and Name-chanting (ध्यानेन नामकीर्तनेन च)

(C) by sleeping

(D) by hoarding wealth

29. The wise person's response to the all-pervading Lord is:

(A) fear and anger

(B) greed and pride

(C) laziness

(D) worship, meditation and Name-chanting

30. ध्यानेन and नामकीर्तनेन are in the _____ case (the means of remembering).

(A) nominative

(B) accusative

(C) vocative

(D) instrumental

31. यक्षाः, गन्धर्वाः and किन्नराः are:

(A) full gods

(B) semi-divine beings

(C) ordinary humans

(D) anti-gods (asuras)

32. Semi-divine beings (upa-deva) are best described as:

(A) classes attending the gods, not gods themselves

(B) the supreme gods

(C) ordinary mortals

(D) demons who fight the gods

33. Calling यक्ष, गन्धर्व and किन्नर 'full gods' is wrong because they are:

(A) above the देव

(B) the same as humans

(C) semi-divine, ranking below the देव

(D) the same as asuras

34. Which is an example of a semi-divine being named in the chapter?

(A) ब्रह्मा (the creator-god)

(B) गन्धर्वः

(C) शृगालः (a fox)

(D) चिकित्सकः (a doctor)

35. In Sanskrit cosmology, the order from highest is roughly:

(A) humans -> gods -> asuras -> semi-divine

(B) देव (gods) -> upa-deva (semi-divine) -> manuShya (humans) -> asura (anti-gods)

(C) asuras -> humans -> gods -> semi-divine

(D) semi-divine -> asuras -> humans -> gods

36. The देव (gods) rank _____ the upa-devas (semi-divine beings).

(A) above

(B) below

(C) equal to

(D) unrelated to

37. The chapter names semi-divine beings to show the universe has:

(A) no order at all

(B) a hierarchy of beings, all within the all-pervading Lord

(C) only humans

(D) only gods

38. दास्यन्ति means:

(A) they gave (past)

(B) they are giving (present)

(C) they should give

(D) they shall / will give

39. The tense of दास्यन्ति is:

(A) present

(B) past

(C) future (IRiT-lakara)

(D) imperative

40. दास्यन्ति is glossed दानं करिष्यन्ति, meaning:

(A) they have given

(B) they will perform giving (will give)

(C) they are giving now

(D) let them give

41. The marker -स्य- in दास्यन्ति signals:

(A) the future tense

(B) the past tense

(C) the plural number

(D) the dative case

42. दास्यन्ति breaks into दा (root) + स्य (future) + न्ति (3rd pl), meaning:

(A) 'they gave'

(B) 'give!'

(C) 'they go'

(D) 'they will give'

43. The PRESENT-tense form 'they give' would be:

(A) ददति / दत्ते

(B) दास्यन्ति

(C) अदुः

(D) देयम्

44. ध्यायन्ति means:

(A) they give

(B) they sleep

(C) they meditate

(D) they quarrel

45. A group of devotees sitting in silent contemplation of God are best described by the verb:

(A) दास्यन्ति (they will give)

(B) विवदन्ते (they quarrel)

(C) ध्यायन्ति (they meditate)

(D) स्वपन्ति (they sleep)

46. कुलकलङ्कः means:

(A) the pride of the family

(B) a stain on the family

(C) a worship ritual

(D) a semi-divine being

47. कुलकलङ्कः breaks into कुल + कलङ्क, meaning:

(A) 'Lord' + 'pervaded'

(B) 'family' + 'stain' = a stain on the family

(C) 'all' + 'power'

(D) 'meditation' + 'chanting'

48. A person whose bad conduct disgraces his family is called a:

(A) सर्वशक्तिमान् (all-powerful)

(B) कुलकलङ्कः (a stain on the family)

(C) गन्धर्वः (a semi-divine being)

(D) चिकित्सकः (a doctor)

49. कुलकलङ्कः is moral vocabulary warning against:

- (A) worshipping God (B) meditating daily
(C) conduct that disgraces one's family (D) giving to others

50. Which word-meaning pair is CORRECT?

- (A) आराधनम् = meditation (B) दास्यन्ति = they gave (past)
(C) कुलकलङ्कः = family pride (D) सर्वशक्तिमान् = all-powerful

51. Which 'how the wise honour God' pair is CORRECT?

- (A) ध्यानम् = worship; नामकीर्तनम् = a stain (B) आराधनम् = future tense
(C) नामकीर्तनम् = a semi-divine being
(D) ध्यानम् = meditation; नामकीर्तनम् = Name-chanting

52. Which grammar pair is CORRECT?

- (A) दास्यन्ति = past tense; -मत् = 'lacking' (B) दास्यन्ति = present; -वत् = dative
(C) दास्यन्ति = future tense; -मत्/-वत् = 'possessing'
(D) -मत् = a future-tense marker

53. Which 'three Brahmas' pair is CORRECT?

- (A) ब्रह्म = a priest; ब्रह्मा = the Absolute
(B) ब्रह्म (neuter) = the Absolute; ब्रह्मा = the creator-god
(C) ब्रह्मन् = the creator-god (D) all three mean exactly the same

54. Which being-type pair is CORRECT?

- (A) गन्धर्वः = semi-divine; ब्रह्मा = a god (creator) (B) गन्धर्वः = a human; किन्नरः = an asura
(C) यक्षः = a full supreme god (D) किन्नरः = a fox

55. The central theme of this chapter is:

- (A) a fox and grapes (B) banking and finance
(C) the all-pervading Lord (ईश) and how the wise honour the Supreme
(D) types of government

56. The verse ईशावास्यम् इदं सर्वम् invites us to see the divine:

- (A) in everything, everywhere (B) only in one temple
(C) nowhere at all (D) only in the sky

57. The chapter pairs the metaphysical verse with grammar; the grammar focus includes:

- (A) the future tense (दास्यन्ति) and the -मत्/-वत् suffix
(B) the dative case only (C) direction words (-तः)
(D) the six tastes

58. Seeing God in all things, a wise person responds with:

- (A) pride and oppression (B) quarrel and greed
(C) indifference

(D) worship, meditation and Name-chanting, not arrogance

59. Putting it together, सर्वशक्तिमान् + ईशावास्यम् इदं सर्वम् together describe a God who is:

(A) powerless and absent

(B) limited to one place

(C) merely a semi-divine being

(D) all-powerful and present everywhere

60. A student claims: 'सर्वशक्तिमान् means powerless, and दास्यन्ति is past tense.' The best correction is:

(A) the student is fully correct

(B) सर्वशक्तिमान् is all-powerful, but दास्यन्ति is past

(C) सर्वशक्तिमान् is powerless, and दास्यन्ति is future

(D) सर्वशक्तिमान् means all-powerful (possessing all power), and दास्यन्ति is future tense ('they shall give')

Solutions — Sanskrit (Class 7), Chapter 7: ईशावास्यम् इदं सर्वम् (Ishavasyam Idam Sarvam)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	C	11	A	21	C	31	B	41	A	51	D
2	A	12	A	22	D	32	A	42	D	52	C
3	D	13	D	23	B	33	C	43	A	53	B
4	B	14	D	24	A	34	B	44	C	54	A
5	C	15	B	25	A	35	B	45	C	55	C
6	A	16	B	26	C	36	A	46	B	56	A
7	A	17	A	27	C	37	B	47	B	57	A
8	D	18	C	28	B	38	D	48	B	58	D
9	C	19	C	29	D	39	C	49	C	59	D
10	B	20	D	30	D	40	B	50	D	60	D

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

- (C)** It means 'all this is pervaded by the Lord'. It does not confine God to temples, deny the divine, or deny a creator.
- (A)** ईशावास्यम् = ईश्वरेण व्याप्तम् = 'pervaded by the Lord'. Not ruled by a king, made of gold, or godless.
- (D)** इदं सर्वम् means 'all this' (the whole world). Not one thing, nothing, or only the temple.
- (B)** The claim is that God pervades everything, everywhere. It is not sky-only, idol-only, or a denial of God.
- (C)** It opens the Ishopanishad. It is not the Ramayana, the Arthashastra, or a fox fable.
- (A)** If the Lord pervades all, one should treat the world with reverence and care - not contempt, greed, or indifference.

7. (A) ईश means 'the Lord'. It has nothing to do with English '-ish', and is not a fox or flower.
8. (D) ईश is from the root ईश् ('to rule, to own'). It does not mean eat, drink, or sleep.
9. (C) ईश्वर ('Lord') is a derivative of ईश. किंशुक (a flower), शृगालः (a fox) and घटः (a pot) are unrelated.
10. (B) ईश is a Sanskrit word for 'Lord' (root ईश्), not an English suffix, a fox, or a number.
11. (A) ईश and ईश्वर share the root ईश् and both name the Supreme. They are not opposites, 'student', or 'sun'.
12. (A) Neuter ब्रह्म is the impersonal Absolute. A priest is ब्रह्मन्, the creator-god ब्रह्मा, and a fox शृगालः.
13. (D) Masculine ब्रह्मन् means a priest. The Absolute is neuter ब्रह्म, the creator-god ब्रह्मा, and a flower पुष्पम्.
14. (D) ब्रह्मा is the creator-god. A priest is ब्रह्मन्, the Absolute neuter ब्रह्म, and a student छात्रः.
15. (B) ईशावास्यम् refers to the neuter ब्रह्म, the all-pervading Absolute. Not the priest, the creator-god, or none.
16. (B) Sanskrit distinguishes the three by gender and spelling. Not by colour, price, or time of day.
17. (A) They look similar but name three different things (the Absolute, a priest, the creator-god). They are not identical, the same, or verbs.
18. (C) सर्वशक्तिमान् means 'all-powerful / omnipotent'. It is not all-knowing, all-seeing, or powerless.
19. (C) सर्व ('all') + शक्ति ('power') + -मत्/-मान् ('possessing') = 'possessing all power'. The other readings are wrong.
20. (D) The -मत्/-वत् suffix means 'possessing'. 'Like' is -वत् in a different sense (समासे); 'lacking' and 'to/for' are wrong here.
21. (C) It describes God as possessing the quality of all-power (omnipotence) - not gadgets, no power, or mere physical strength.
22. (D) The suffix marks possession of the quality of all-power, not a plural of objects, a tense, or a case.
23. (B) बुद्धिमान् means 'possessing intelligence', using the same -मत्/-वत् suffix. Not 'lacking', 'like', or 'to'.

24. (A) आराधनम् means 'worship'. Meditation is ध्यानम्, Name-chanting नामकीर्तनम्, and a stain कलङ्कः.

25. (A) ध्यानम् means 'meditation'. Worship is आराधनम्, Name-chanting नामकीर्तनम्, and a family कुलम्.

26. (C) नामकीर्तनम् is chanting/singing the Name in praise. Worship is आराधनम्, meditation ध्यानम्, and a family-stain कुलकलङ्कः.

27. (C) नाम ('Name') + कीर्तनम् ('praise-singing') = chanting the Name. The other splits are wrong.

28. (B) The wise remember God by meditation and Name-chanting. Not by quarrelling, sleeping, or hoarding wealth.

29. (D) The wise respond with worship, meditation and Name-chanting - not fear, greed, or laziness.

30. (D) They are instrumental, the means of remembering. Not nominative, accusative, or vocative.

31. (B) They are semi-divine beings (upa-deva). Not full gods, ordinary humans, or asuras.

32. (A) Semi-divine beings attend the gods but are not gods themselves. They are not the supreme gods, mere mortals, or anti-god demons.

33. (C) They are semi-divine, below the देवस (gods). They are not above the gods, the same as humans, or asuras.

34. (B) गन्धर्वः is a semi-divine being. ब्रह्मा is a god (creator), शृगालः a fox, and चिकित्सकः a doctor.

35. (B) The order is gods -> semi-divine -> humans -> anti-gods. The other orders scramble the hierarchy.

36. (A) The gods rank above the semi-divine beings. Not below, equal, or unrelated.

37. (B) Naming semi-divine beings shows a hierarchy of beings, all within the all-pervading Lord. Not no order, only humans, or only gods.

38. (D) दास्यन्ति means 'they shall/will give' (future). It is not past, present, or an imperative 'should give'.

39. (C) दास्यन्ति is future tense (लृट्-लकार). It is not present, past, or imperative.

40. (B) दास्यन्ति = दानं करिष्यन्ति = 'they will give'. Not 'have given', 'are giving now', or 'let them give'.

41. (A) The -स्य- marker signals the future tense. It does not mark past tense, plural, or the dative.

42. (D) दा + स्य + न्ति = 'they will give'. Not 'they gave', 'give!', or 'they go'.

43. (A) The present 'they give' is ददति / दत्ते. दास्यन्ति is future, अदुः a past form, and देयम् a gerundive.

44. (C) ध्यायन्ति means 'they meditate'. They give is ददति, sleep स्वपन्ति, and quarrel विवदन्ते.

45. (C) Silent contemplation is ध्यायन्ति (they meditate). Not 'they will give', 'they quarrel', or 'they sleep'.

46. (B) कुलकलङ्कः means 'a stain on the family'. Not family pride, a ritual, or a semi-divine being.

47. (B) कुल ('family') + कलङ्क ('stain') = a stain on the family. The other splits are wrong.

48. (B) Such a person is a कुलकलङ्कः (a stain on the family). The others mean all-powerful, semi-divine, or a doctor.

49. (C) It warns against conduct that disgraces one's family - not against worship, meditation, or giving.

50. (D) सर्वशक्तिमान् = all-powerful. आराधनम् is worship (not meditation), दास्यन्ति is future (not past), and कुलकलङ्कः is a family-stain (not pride).

51. (D) ध्यानम् = meditation and नामकीर्तनम् = Name-chanting. The other options misdefine these terms.

52. (C) दास्यन्ति is future, and -मत्/-वत् means 'possessing'. The other pairings are wrong.

53. (B) ब्रह्म (neuter) is the Absolute and ब्रह्मा the creator-god. ब्रह्मन् is a priest; they do not all mean the same.

54. (A) गन्धर्वः is semi-divine and ब्रह्मा a (creator) god. The other options misclassify the beings.

55. (C) The theme is the all-pervading Lord and how the wise honour the Supreme. It is not the fox fable, banking, or government.

56. (A) The verse invites us to see the divine in everything, everywhere - not in one temple, nowhere, or only the sky.

57. (A) The grammar focus includes the future tense (दास्यन्ति) and the -मत्/-वत् suffix. Not only the dative, direction words, or tastes.

58. (D) Seeing God in all, the wise respond with worship, meditation and Name-chanting - not arrogance, greed, or indifference.

59. (D) Together they describe a God who is all-powerful and present everywhere - not powerless, local, or semi-divine.

60. (D) सर्वशक्तिमान् means all-powerful, and दास्यन्ति is future tense. The other options keep one or both errors.